How SmartThings and AI are changing your home

Samsung's **Ghufran Alam** explains

Bharat Upadhyay | editor@digit.in

Samsung recently launched its 2026 Bespoke AI appliances lineup in India. The new range includes AI-powered refrigerators, air conditioners and washing machines, with features designed to make everyday home tasks easier. The lineup includes the Family Hub Refrigerator with AI Vision built with Google Gemini, the Bespoke AI WindFree Pro Air Conditioner and the Infinite 1-Way Cassette AC with WindFree.



Ghufran Alam
Vice President and Head of Digital Appliances at Samsung India

The South Korean tech giant says these products can help users manage appliances, save energy and control different devices through its SmartThings platform.

During a media round table at the event, Ghufran Alam, Vice President and Head of Digital Appliances at Samsung India, explained how the company is looking at AI beyond smartphones and bringing it into everyday home appliances.

Alam said that AI is no longer only about hype. "I think what we need to know is, first of all, that there's no more hype. In fact, if you look at the data, the data shows a lot of things," Alam told Digit.

He explained that Samsung is looking at the number of users who are actively using its connected ecosystem instead of only counting the number of people who have installed the SmartThings app.

According to the senior Samsung India executive, the company has around 25 million monthly active users on its connected platform.

"When we are looking at monthly active users, it is like growing 30 per cent from last year. And it's a substantial base. Around 25 million consumers are monthly active users," he said.

Alam stressed that the active usage of connected services shows that consumers are not only buying AI-enabled devices but are also using the features available on them.

"When they are buying AI-enabled devices, they are also using it. And they know that the benefits of AI are in the AI devices. For Samsung, it's very unique in a way," he said.

One of Samsung's key focus areas is its multi-device ecosystem. Unlike brands that focus on one product category, Samsung has smartphones, televisions, smartwatches, tablets, laptops, earbuds and home appliances under its portfolio.

"The multi-device experience is a kind of one whole cycle because Samsung provides not only appliances, but also televisions, mobile phones, audio devices, smartwatches, tablets and laptops. So anything, everything which is kind of from the consumer electronics perspective is there with Samsung," Alam explained.

"That is very exciting when you look at the multi-device experience and connected devices," he added.

According to Alam, Samsung's AI-enabled devices are designed to communicate with each other. This means that a smartwatch can share information with an air conditioner, while a refrigerator can use AI to understand food items and suggest recipes.

Samsung wants to make AI more affordable

While AI features are often associated with expensive premium products, Alam said Samsung does not want consumers to believe that AI is available only on high-end appliances.

According to Alam, Indian consumers are aspirational across different regions, age groups and backgrounds.

"We feel that Indians are very aspirational. Irrespective of geographies, irrespective of gender, irrespective of different age groups, they're very aspirational," he said.

He also added that Samsung has seen a really strong adoption of new technologies across many different appliance categories.

The Korean giant is working on two areas, according to Alam. The first is offering more affordable AI-enabled products, while the second is making AI available across more categories and product types.

He noted that AI features were earlier limited to only the ultra-premium products, but the company is now bringing them to more affordable models and lineups.